Oliver Cassagneau-Francis
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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Senior Research Fellow 2024 –
Centre for Education Policy and Equalising Opportunities (CEPEO), UCL

Research Fellow 2022 – 2024
Centre for Education Policy and Equalising Opportunities (CEPEO), UCL

Affiliated Researcher
Department for Education, through the Economics of Education Research Centre (EERC)

EDUCATION

PhD, Economics. Sciences Po. 2017 – 2022
Thesis: Essays in skills and education.
Advisors: Professor Ghazala Azmat & Professor Jean-Marc Robin.

MRes, Economics, Sciences Po. 2015 – 2017
Summa cum laude (top 2%).

Advanced Diploma, Economics. University of Cambridge. 2013 – 2014

BSc, Mathematics and Chemistry, University of Birmingham. 2008 – 2012
First-class honours.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Economics of education; labour economics; applied microeconometrics; inequality and climate change.

WORKING PAPERS

"Measuring systematic gaps in teacher judgement: A new approach", with L. Macmillan, R. Murphy and G. Wyness, Oct. 2025.

"Private highs: Investigating university overmatch among students from elite schools", with Jo Blanden, Lindsey Macmillan and Gill Wyness, July 2025.

"Estimating heterogeneous returns to college by cognitive and non-cognitive ability". Sep. 2025.

"The role of earnings, financial, and other factors in university attendance", Feb. 2023.

"Individual differences in risk aversion and delay discounting in late adolescence: The effects of childhood emotional and behavioural problems", (with D. Kelly, M. Francesconi and E. Flourini). *New WP coming soon.*

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

"The merits of teacher assessment versus external exams to measure student achievement", with G. Wyness, *IZA World of Labor*, 517, June 2025.
"The potential effects of the cost of living crisis on children's outcomes", with D. Kelly. *CEPEO Briefing Note Series*, 17, December 2022.
"The myth of the 'small patent for the small inventor'–strategic motives to use second-tier patent systems (utility models) in selected European countries", with A. Radauer, C. Rosemberg, H. Goddar and C. Haarmann, *Journal of Intellectual Property Law & Practice*, 14(10), October 2019, 771–783.
"L'impact de la formation professionnelle en France : une première exploration sur les données Défis du Céreq", with R. Gary-Bobo, J. Pernaudet and J.-M. Robin, in *Formation continue et parcours*

professionnels, Céreq Échanges, 15, 2020.
"Degrees of choice", with J. Blanden, L. Macmillan and G. Wyness, *CentrePiece*, 31(1), Spring 2026 (lead article).

Work in progress

"Teacher leniency and the impact of higher education mismatch on earnings", with L. Macmillan, R. Murphy and G. Wyness.
"Beyond teacher assessed grades: Post 16 education choices and Covid-19", with L. Macmillan and G. Wyness.
"Occupational Hazard 2: Measuring inequalities in match to occupations using linked employer-employee data", with L. Macmillan, R. Murphy, F. Petit and G. Wyness.
"A non-parametric finite-mixture approach to difference-in-difference estimation, with an application to professional training and wages", with R. Gary-Bobo, J. Pernaudet and J.-M. Robin.

Grants and awards

Nuffield Foundation grant, HE admissions and match (PI, c. £240,000, *under review*)	2026
EERC (DfE), school absences project (Co-I)	
ESRC Impact Acceleration Account (IAA) award (Co-I, £19,613)	2024 – 2025
Nuffield Foundation Research Grant (Co-I, £177,647)	2025 – 2026
ADR UK Research Fellowship (PI, £176,314)	2023 – 2025
Doctoral School Scholarship, Sciences Po	2017 – 2020
Summa cum laude honours (top 2% in MRes), Sciences Po	2017
Natural Sciences Award, University of Birmingham	2009

Conference and seminar presentations

2025: HKLM, FourSaNE, SES, IWAEE.
2024: RES, SES, IWAEE, WEEP.
Pre-2024: IWAEE (poster), WEEP (NTNU), HKLM Seminar (UCL-IFS), EWMES (Manchester), RES (poster), UCL-IAB Workshop (UCL), Empirical Micro PhD Workshop (Cambridge), Sciences Po Lunch Seminar.

Previous employment

GES summer internship, Department for Transport	2016
Economic consultant, Technopolis	2014 – 2015

Teaching

Co-lead and lecturer, Economics of Education (UG, Year 2), UCL	2025 –
Lecturer, Evaluation Methods (ADR UK professional course)	2026
Lecturer, Practical Introduction to LEO (ADR UK professional course)	2025 –
Seminar leader, Intro to Economics I (UG), UCL	2023 – 2025
Seminar leader, Macroeconomics (Graduate), Sciences Po	2021
Seminar leader, Labour Economics (Graduate), Sciences Po	2020–2021
Lecturer, Mathematics Bootcamp (Graduate), Sciences Po	2020–2021
Lecturer, Introduction to Econometrics (UG), Sciences Po	2018–2019
Head seminar leader, Intermediate Microeconomics (UG), Sciences Po	2017 – 2020
Seminar leader, Graduate Microeconomics 3 (Graduate), Sciences Po	2017 – 2018

Supervision and service

Line manager, Research Fellow, CEPEO	2026 –
Dissertation supervisor, Arts and Sciences (BASc), UCL	2026 – 2027
PhD mentor, ADR UK	2026 –
Project supervisor, master's-level Macroeconomics and Econometrics, Sciences Po	2017 – 2021
Organiser, CEPEO seminar series	2023 – 2025
Contributor, development of the LEO dataset and synthetic LEO	

References (click names to email)

Lindsey Macmillan	Gill Wyness	Richard Murphy	Jean-Marc Robin
Professor	Professor	Assoc. Professor	Professor
UCL	UCL	UT Austin	Sciences Po
CEPEO	CEPEO	Dept. of Economics	Dept. of Economics